Yoritomo's brothers. As the enemy closed in, the Emperor's grandmother took her grandson in her arms and leapt from the ship. They were followed by their courtiers and by the defeated Taira samurai, dragged to the bottom by their armor.

Munemori, who had been responsible for the defeat at Kurikara Pass and had not managed to distinguish himself since, refused to jump until one of the Taira courtiers, embarrassed by his leader's cowardice, pushed him off the side. He was a good swimmer, though, and one of the Minamoto boats fished him out of the water and took him prisoner. He was beheaded at Kamakura a few days later.

Later, one of the surviving members of his family remarked that Munemori's disgraceful behavior wasn't surprising; everyone in the clan knew that he wasn't a real Taira. His mother had confided to them all, after the debacle of Kurikara, that she'd bought him from an umbrella seller as a baby.[7]

With the mass drownings, the history of the Taira in Japan came to an abrupt and utter end. Minamoto Yoritomo claimed the lordship of Japan, driving his cousin from Kyoto and taking for himself the prestigious title of *utaisho*, Commander of the Inner Palace Guards: a warrior's title for a victorious fighter. Another of Go-Shirakawa's grandsons, the three-year-old Go-Toba, was crowned Emperor. But Yoritomo controlled Japan's fighting forces, and the Cloistered Emperor Go-Shirakawa, who had an unerring instinct for staying on the right side in a fight, recognized his rule. The struggle for power had ended as it began, with a toddler on the throne and power in the hands of others.[8]

Seven years later, in 1192, Yoritomo accepted from the young Emperor's hands the title of *shogun*: Military Commander in Chief, supreme commander of Japan. The authority to rule had shifted again, from Cloistered Emperor to soldier; and for many centuries to come, the shogun would rule as second emperor of Japan.